

PLANT PROTECTION IMPORTATION GUIDELINES

An **IMPORT PERMIT** must be obtained for all regulated plant commodities, in any quantity. The permit should be obtained ahead of export of commodities from the country of export, using the following steps:

1. An application for an Import Permit **MUST** be submitted to Plant Protection at least two (2) weeks before the shipping date.
2. The application should comprise three (3) hard copies of a printed invoice/order form/purchase order, etc. and one (1) completed Plant Protection Import Permit Application Form. *[The Application Form can be provided via email or in hard copy from Plant Protection].*
3. **Plants for planting pose the highest level of pest risk.** All plants for planting therefore **MUST** have a valid import permit along with other required documentation as stated on the permit issued for the consignment. Consignments that do not comply **WILL BE CONFISCATED**.
4. Permits are valid for one (1) consignment only, and expire 60 days from the date of issue.

All inbound consignments of regulated plant commodities must be accompanied by a valid **PHYTOSANITARY CERTIFICATE** issued by the Plant Protection Organisation of the country of export upon presentation of the Import Permit and the commodities to be exported to Antigua and Barbuda.

The following provides examples of commodity categories that require an Import Permit:

1. Plants intended for planting –
 - Cuttings
 - Seeds
 - Tubers for planting
 - *In vitro* plants (that is, tissue culture plants)
 - Micropropagative plant material
 - Live plants
2. Plant commodities that have not been processed and are intended for consumption, processing, and other purposes other than propagation –
 - Fresh fruits & vegetables
 - Cut flowers
 - Wood & wood products/items
3. Plant commodities that have been processed but remain capable of being infested with some quarantine pests –
 - Chipped wood
 - Chopped fruit, nuts, grains & vegetables
 - Crushed herbs & nuts
 - Dehydrated fruit & vegetables
 - Fibres
 - Painted wood
 - Peeled or shelled fruits, vegetables, grains & nuts
 - Polished rice & cocoa beans
 - Graded, sorted, washed or brushed &/or waxed fruit & vegetables
 - Chilled fruits & vegetables
4. Plant growth media (e.g., soil, soil substitutes, mulches, potting mixes), aggregates, sand, etc.

Issued by:

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